were planning to organise a three-day protest on long-pending issues of employees of public sector undertakings in the country. Speaking to mediapersons here on Sunday, he said that representatives of trade unions would be meeting on September 4 in Delhi to discuss the issue. He criticised government for considering either to privatise or close down sick units and said that workers have to resist these efforts. He appealed to railway employees also to join hands to fight against government. He said that some banks were also going to be privatised. INTUC state general secretary Dr K.S. Mohan Kumar also participated.

WOMAN ENDS LIFE DUE TO POVERTY

Visakhapatnam: A woman committed suicide by hanging herself from a ceiling fan at her home in the Gnanapuram area under Kancharapalem police station limits in the city on Sunday morning. Police said P. Vasanthi, 48, a widow, took the extreme step due to poverty. A few years ago, she had lost her husband and faced many financial problems, said the police.

REALTOR HELD FOR CHEQUE BOUNCE

Visakhapatnam: Police arrested a real estate businessman on Sunday in a cheque bounce case. According to reports, P. Tirumala Rao, a resident of Lalithanagar area in the city

Rehab centre for spinal cord patients

DC CORRESPONDENT
VISAKHAPATNAM, AUG. 12

A post-hospitalisation rehabilitation centre, especially for persons with spinal cord injuries, is coming up in the city, to provide holistic services like treatment, professional and personal improvement for patients shortly.

The GVMC is supporting the cause by providing a place in the city for a local community based organisation, the Ability People. The centre will accommodate 30 persons initially.

A study by Dr. Ketna reveals that there are around 20,000 cases of spine injuries in the state with no rehabilitation centre for spinal cord injuries (SCI) available.

The Christian Medical College in Vellore, Tamil Nadu, is the only one with a rehab centre in the entire South India with inpatient facility.

Statistics also reveal that there are 500 to 600 new cases of spine injuries in Andhra Pradesh every year.

The organisation will enter into an MoU with the Greater Visakhapatnam Municipal Corporation (GVMC) for land and other basic amenities.

The GVMC is supporting the cause by providing a place for a local organisation the Ability People

The main objective of setting up the centre is to develop post-hospital rehabilitation for people with disabilities, especially spinal cord injury patients, for their educational, sports, and vocational rehabilitation. The proposed centre will cater to the needs of paralysis, neurological strokes, post fracture complications, arthritis, spondylitis and back aches.

Organisers are also planning to reduce the patient's dependence on drugs, relieve pain, improve mobility, strengthen muscles and enhance self-reliance.

Mr Dilip Patro, the president of The Ability People, is a wheelchair user after a spinal cord injury.

MAN'S DEATH SPARKS PROTEST IN HOSPITAL

DC CORRESPONDENT
VISAKHAPATNAM,
AUG. 12

The death of a man in a private clinic in the Pedawaltair area in Vizag city sparked protests by his family members who alleged that negligence of medical staff led to the man's death. Hospital authorities denied the allegations.

According to reports, A. Venkata Rao was admitted in the clinic



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